Do Now feedback

Checking responses and addressing gaps

Use a proportionate review so Do Now both strengthens recall and informs teaching. Gather the answers first, then decide which items need confirmation, discussion or a brief repair.

How to do it well

1 Collect independent responses. Use boards, a bounded written answer or a deliberate sample before revealing the solution.

2 Identify the pattern. Distinguish isolated slips, missing knowledge and a shared misconception; note students whose response remains unclear.

3 Choose the smallest useful response. Confirm secure items briefly, discuss genuine differences or re-model the point causing widespread difficulty.

4 Recheck the repaired idea. Use a fresh question with comparable demand and enough change to require independent thinking.

5 Reschedule the knowledge. Record the item for later retrieval and follow up individual gaps during subsequent teaching or practice.

What this sounds like

“Most of us have question one secure, so I will confirm it briefly. Question three shows two different ideas; let us compare those before trying a related question.”

Classroom example. A class answers most Do Now items accurately, but several confuse evaporation with boiling. The teacher confirms secure items briefly, contrasts the two ideas and asks a fresh question about a puddle drying. That response informs the next move. The distinction returns in a later Do Now instead of consuming the entire starter today.

Top tips that make the technique work

Do not give every item equal time. A nearly universal correct response rarely needs the same explanation as a common misconception.

Keep the solution hidden while scanning. An early answer changes what later responses can tell you.

Ask for a fresh response after repair. A slightly changed question shows more than asking students to copy the corrected answer.

Use discussion when it has a purpose. Compare different plausible responses, then return to an individual answer so the evidence remains usable.

Record fragile knowledge. Revisit it in future retrieval rather than trying to solve every long-term issue in today’s starter.

Do and avoid

Do	Avoid
Choose the response from the pattern of answers.	Asking only volunteers for their answers.
Keep the review concise and consequential.	Automatically reteaching every question in full.

Further reading

Practitioner guidance; teacher language above is an illustrative BSCS adaptation.

Barton - Do Now | Barton - A model for responsive teaching